Describing a process

Objective: To describe a scientific or technical process clearly, step by step, using sequencers and the passive voice.

The idea in two lines: A process description explains **how something is done or how it happens**. It follows a logical order, links the stages with sequencers and usually uses the present simple passive because the focus is on the action, not on the person.

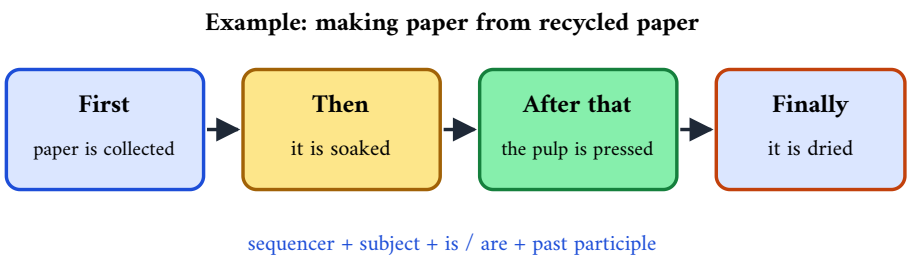


Figure 1: A process presented in ordered stages, each introduced by a sequencer and written in the passive.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Order:** present the stages in the real chronological order of the process.
2. **Sequencers:** first / firstly, then, next, after that, afterwards, finally; *once / after + clause* to link two stages.
3. **Present simple passive:** is / are + past participle: *The mixture is heated.*
4. **Imperative** is used in instructions (experiments, recipes): *Pour the water. Stir well.*
5. **Purpose and result** can be added: *The liquid is filtered to remove impurities.*
6. **Structure of the paragraph:** introduction (what the process is), stages, conclusion (the final product).

🟢 Examples

1. Rewrite in the passive: "We boil the water." **Answer:** First, the water *is boiled.*

2. Order and link the stages: (pick the olives / press them / wash them / store the oil). **Answer:** First, the olives are picked. Then, they are washed. After that, they are pressed. Finally, the oil is stored. **Explanation:** logical order + sequencers + passive.
3. Join with *once*: "The paper is dry. It is cut." **Answer:** *Once* the paper is dry, it is cut.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Listing steps without **sequencers**, so the text reads like a list.
- Mixing tenses: keep the **present simple** for a general process.
- Forgetting *is / are* in the passive: *The juice filtered* ×.
- Using *finally* for a middle stage.

🟡 Quick review

- Logical, chronological order.
- First → then → next → after that → finally.
- Present simple passive for the stages.
- Imperative for instructions.
- Introduce and conclude the process.

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